VAYU | YOUR PERSONAL CROP GUIDE

Turmeric

How to grow it on your land

Prepared for: General guide (no location chosen)
Prepared on 2026-11-11

Well-known crop with strong ICAR-IISR guidance and a ready market, but it needs a lot of seed rhizome, mulch, water and careful rot prevention, and the price swings.

DIFFICULTY	MONEY NEEDED	RISK	FIRST RETURN
3 of 5	**Medium**	**Medium**	**harvest about 6-9 months after planting**

How to read this guide: [S1] marks a line backed by a source listed on the last page. (general knowledge) marks a line that has not been verified against a source. Lines starting **For your land** use the numbers for your location.

In this guide

- Your priorities: what to do first, in order
- Your planting plan: how much to buy and prepare for your plot
- How to grow it: planting, water, nutrition, pests and diseases, monitoring, harvest, risks
- If your conditions are different, and the sources behind every line

Your land at a glance

Your priorities

Ordered by what matters most on your land.

1. Get your soil tested
Satellite and model data estimate soil pH and texture only roughly, and cannot see nutrients, salinity or soil health. Get a proper soil test (pH, organic carbon, nutrients, salinity) from your KVK or the state soil-testing laboratory; the Soil Health Card scheme provides this. (general knowledge)

2. Talk to your KVK first
Take this guide to your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra and ask for their local advice and trusted planting material. (general knowledge)

3. Start small
Plant or build a small trial first. Learn the crop on your own land, then expand from what actually worked. (general knowledge)

4. Line up a buyer before you scale
Know who will buy, in what form and grade, and how it will reach them. (general knowledge)

Your planting plan for 1 acre

What	How much	Basis
Rhizome pieces at 0.5 m x 0.25 m	**about 32,374**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1, S4]
Seed rhizomes (about 2,000-2,500 kg per hectare)	**0.8 to 1.0 tonnes**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]
Farmyard manure or compost (30-40 tonnes per hectare)	**12 to 16 tonnes**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]
Green-leaf mulch (12-15 tonnes per hectare)	**4.9 to 6.1 tonnes**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1, S5]

Sums of the cited per-plant and per-hectare amounts for your plot size. Real needs vary with soil and variety; confirm with your KVK.

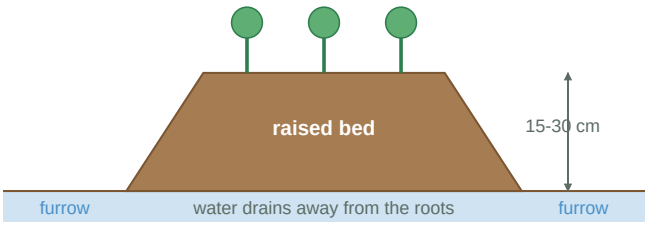
Planting material

- Use whole or split mother and finger rhizomes that are healthy and disease-free. About 2,000-2,500 kg of rhizome is needed for one hectare. [S2, S1]
- ICAR-IISR (Kozhikode) varieties include IISR Prabha, Prathibha, Kedaram and Alleppey Supreme; the IISR Experimental Farm, Peruvannamuzhi supplies planting material. [S1]
- Where nematodes occur use only healthy, nematode-free rhizomes. [S1]

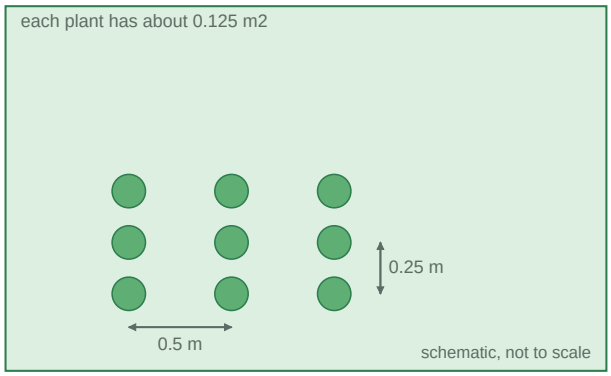
Land preparation and planting

- Prepare land with the first monsoon showers (fine tilth, four deep ploughings). Plant in April-May with pre-monsoon showers in Kerala and the west coast; other regions follow local advice. [S1, S4]
- Plant in pits about 25 x 30 cm on raised beds, or on ridges 45-60 cm apart with 25 cm between plants. [S1, S4]
- Spread 30-40 tonnes per hectare of farmyard manure or compost basally. [S1]

- Mulch immediately after planting with green leaves (about 12-15 tonnes per hectare) and repeat at about 40 and 90 days. [S1, S5]



Raised bed with drainage furrows



Plant spacing, top view

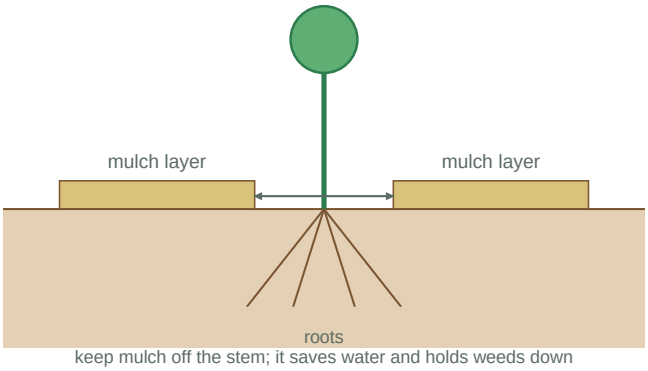
Irrigation

- Rainfed in high-rainfall areas; otherwise irrigate regularly (about 15-23 times in clay, about 40 in sandy loam). [S3]
- Keep beds drained between irrigations. [S2]

Nutrition (organic)

- For organic production: farmyard manure (about 40 t/ha) with vermicompost (5-10 t/ha) and green-leaf mulch; neem cake at about 25 g per planting pit. [S5, S6]

- Pour cow-dung slurry over beds after each mulching to boost soil microbes. [S7]

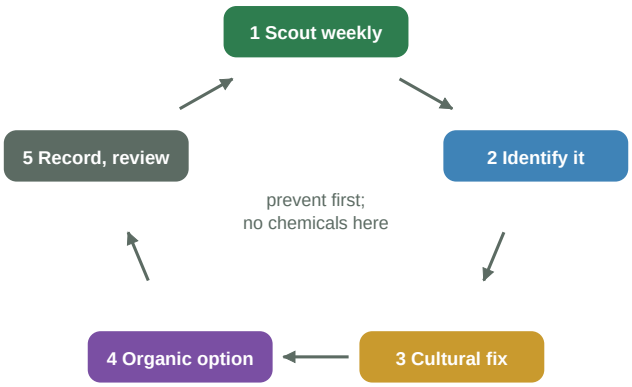


Mulch around a plant

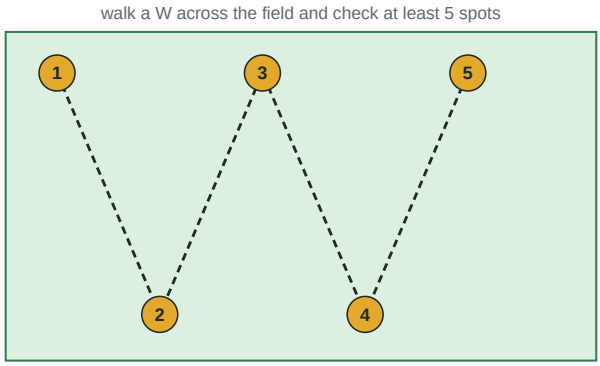
Pests and diseases (organic and cultural only)

- Rhizome rot is the major disease: use healthy rhizomes, raised drained beds, Trichoderma-enriched compost at planting, and treat seed rhizomes with Trichoderma viride or Pseudomonas. [S6, S8]
- Shoot borer is the most serious pest: scout regularly, cut open affected shoots, pick out the larvae and destroy them. [S1, S7]
- Nematodes: healthy seed and more soil organic matter help; the biocontrol fungus Pochonia chlamydosporia is used in beds (ask your KVK for a source). [S1]
- ICAR guidance includes chemical options; this guide does not reproduce them. (general knowledge)

- For anything beyond these organic and cultural steps, ask the nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university for their current recommendation. (general knowledge)



Pest and disease loop: prevent first, then look, fix, review



How to walk the field when scouting

Monitoring

- Weekly: look at the collar of the plant for water-soaked softness (rot), leaf spots and blotches, and 'dead-heart' shoots (borer). (general knowledge)
- Weed at about 60, 90 and 120 days after planting. [S4]

Harvest, yield and post-harvest

- Harvest when leaves yellow and dry; ICAR-IISR varieties such as Prabha (about 37.5 t/ha) and Prathibha (about 39 t/ha) reported fresh rhizome yields in about 190-195 days. [S1]
- Cure by boiling the rhizomes in fresh water then sun-drying for about 10-15 days, or dry with hot air up to about 60 C. [S7]
- Store seed rhizomes heaped in shade or a well-ventilated place covered with turmeric leaves. [S7]

Risks and costs

- Seed is the biggest input (about two tonnes per hectare), so a failed or rotted crop is costly. [S1]
- For certified organic sale the crop must be under organic management for about 18 months to 2 years, with a buffer zone from non-organic neighbours. [S6, S9]
- Price changes a lot season to season; confirm a buyer before a large planting. (general knowledge)

If your conditions are different

What to do if your land, or the season, turns out different from the numbers above.

- **Heavy soil** (fixable): Good drainage is essential and heavy clay stays wet, which causes rhizome rot. Plant on raised beds about 15-30 cm high with drains between them. [S2, S3]
- **Low rainfall** (fixable): Under about 1,500 mm of rain it needs irrigation: about 15-23 irrigations in clayey soils and about 40 in sandy loam. Confirm you have reliable water for the whole crop before planting. [S1, S3]
- **Too much rain** (fixable): Good drainage is essential. Plant on raised beds (about 15-30 cm high) with drains between them; waterlogging causes rhizome rot. [S2, S3]

- **Soil pH** (fixable): It tolerates a wide range (about 4.5-7.5). Add compost; on laterite soils lime is applied per local advice, so get a soil test. [S2, S4]
- **Cold weather** (fixable): It is a tropical crop and is not frost tolerant; do not plant where winter frost occurs during growth. In cool sites delay planting until danger has passed. (general knowledge)
- **Heat** (fixable): Grown up to about 35 C as a normal range; mulch and irrigate more in heat. [S1]

About chemicals

This guide gives organic and cultural methods only. It does not name or dose pesticides, fungicides or chemical fertilisers; for those, follow your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university and the label of any registered product.

Sources

[S1] https://en.vikaspedia.in/agriculture/crop-production/package-of-practices/spices/turmeric
[S2] https://indianspices.com/sites/default/files/cultivation_practices-TURMERIC-1.pdf
[S3] https://www.slideshare.net/RajaChaudhary24/package-of-practices-for-turmericpptx
[S4] https://vikaspedia.in/agriculture/crop-production/package-of-practices/spices/turmeric
[S5] https://aicrps.res.in/Extension Pamphlets/Ginger/English/Ginger and Turmeric cultivation Practices in Nagaland.pdf
[S6] https://celkau.in/crops/Spices/Turmeric/organic_farming.aspx
[S7] https://old.celkau.in/Crops/Spices/Turmeric/organic_farming.aspx
[S8] https://aicrps.res.in/Extension Pamphlets/Ginger/English/Ginger and Turmeric cultivation Practices in Nagaland.pdf
[S9] https://en.vikaspedia.in/viewcontent/agriculture/crop-production/package-of-practices/spices/turmeric?lgn=en

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